

UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX

Undergraduate Examinations 2017

CURRENT DISPUTES IN SOCIOLOGY: SOCIOLOGICAL ANALYSIS III

Time allowed: **THREE** hours

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

The paper consists of **17** questions in total.

All questions are of equal weight.

Candidates are permitted to bring into the examination room, and consult, hardcopy English Language dictionaries. Subject dictionaries are not allowed.

Please do not leave your seat unless you are given permission by an invigilator. Do not communicate in any way with any other candidate in the examination room. Do not open the question paper until told to do so. All answers must be written in the answer book(s) provided. All rough work must be written in the answer book(s) provided. A line should be drawn through any rough work to indicate to the examiner that it is not part of the work to be marked. At the end of the examination, remain seated until your answer book(s) have been collected and you have been told you may leave.

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

SECTION A

1. Critically examine the argument that sociology needs to adopt the same methods as those of natural science in order to be able to produce knowledge about the social world.
2. “The role of sociology is to *interpret* the social world. The natural world is none of its concern.” Critically analyse this statement.
3. “One of the most urgent tasks for contemporary sociology is to develop ways of thinking about the relations between society and the environment”. Critically discuss this statement using the work of at least two social theorists.
4. Outline and assess how far postmodernists have challenged traditional approaches to sociology.
5. What does Barthes mean when he describes contemporary society as full of “myths”. How convincing is his argument?
6. Critically analyse Bourdieu’s concept of “cultural capital” and its relevance for understanding society today.
7. Outline and assess at least two sociological arguments for why the rich are becoming richer across the world.
8. In what ways, if at all, can experience be used as a theoretical basis for feminism?
9. Outline and assess feminist approaches to epistemology.

END OF SECTION A

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

SECTION B

10. Outline and assess Foucault's approach to understanding power.
11. Critically examine Du Bois' concept of "double consciousness" and its relevance for analysis of race/ethnicity today.
12. Using the work of at least two writers, critically examine the challenge that post-colonial theory has made to traditional sociological approaches.
13. "The way we see the world is not innocent". Critically examine this statement.
14. Why should the body be of interest to sociologists?
15. "Humans are born either male or female". Critically examine the conceptual presumptions of this statement.
16. Outline and assess the ways in which Bruno Latour has challenged traditional approaches to sociology. How convincing do you find his arguments?
17. What is the role of social theory today? How can it help us rethink our values and our world?

END OF SECTION B

END OF PAPER